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The world has achieved brilliance w/o wisdom, power w/o conscience. Ours is a world of nuclear giants and ethical infants."

Women Empowerment

From Sultana's Dream (1905)

what is the matter, dear? she said affectionately.

I feel somewhat awkward", I said in a rather apologising tone, "as being a purdahnishin woman I am not accustomed to walking about unveiled."

You need not be afraid of coming across a man here. This is Ladyland, free from sin and harm."

I became very curious to know where the men were. I met more than a 100 women while walking there, but not a single man.

"Where are the men?" I asked her.

"In their proper places, where they ought to be."

"I pray let me know what you mean by "their proper places"

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Oh, I see my mistake, you cannot know our customs as you were never here before. We shut our men indoors".

Just as we are kept in the zenana?

Exactly so!

- In her dream, Sultana visits a magical country where gender roles are reversed. Men are confined to the home and observe purdah while women are busy scientists trying with each other at inventing devices that will control the clouds & regulate rain and machines that fly or 'air cars'.

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Collapse of Education

At the entrance gate of a uni in S. Africa, the following message was posted :

"Destroying any nation does not require the use of atomic bombs or the use of long range missiles. It only requires lowering the quality of edu" & allowing cheating in the exams."

Patients die at the hands of such doctors.
Building collapse - - - - - - - - engineers.
Money is lost at the hands of such economists & A/Cants.
Humanity dies at - - - - - - - - religious scholars
Justice is lost - - - - - - - judges.

The collapse of edu" is the collapse of the nation!

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Private initiative

Founder of Tesla Motors company, Elon Musk released all Tesla patents to help fight CC, save the Earth. It was a remarkable move in an industry where the smallest idea or seed of innovation is carefully guarded to protect its monetary value. Tesla Motors was created to accelerate the advent of sustainable transport.

Women fighting odds

Marie Curie, the 1st woman to win a Nobel Prize, the 1st person to win twice & the only person to win a Nobel Prize in 2 diff sciences couldn't legally attend college because she was a woman. She went to an illegal school that worked underground. Her husband refused to accept it alone

Elon Musk

Elon wanted a safe payment method, so he created 'Paypal'. He wanted to drive an electric car, so he founded 'Tesla Motors'. He wanted to go to space & hence

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स्वस्य स्वल्पं, समाजाय सर्वस्वं । - A little bit for yourself and everything (a lot) for others.

The one who plants trees, knowing that he will never sit in their shade, has at least started to understand the meaning of life. - RN Tagore.

तत् दूरे तत् वंतिके - It is far, yet it is within.

Never Give up / Positive Attitude

On the night of Dec 9, 1914, Edison Industries were destroyed by fire. The loss exceeded 2mn dollars, along with the majority of Thomas Edison's work. At 67 yrs of age, the great Inventor watched his life's work go up in flames. The next morning, he surveyed his charred dreams & crushed hopes.

As he looked at the scene, he said

" There is a great value in disaster. All our mistakes are burned up. Thank God we can start anew. "

3 weeks after the fire, Edison produced one of his greatest inventions : {The 1st phonograph}

SO the final word is : YOU CAN START AGAIN.

Fall 7 times, stand up 8! <3

Education is not only for Employment but also Empowerment & Enlightenment.

The Internet is becoming the town square for the global village of 2morrow - Bill Gates

The world is round & the place which may seem like the end may also be the beginning.

1000s of candles can be lighted from a single candle & the life of the candle will not be shortened. Happiness never decreases by being shared. - Buddha

In a gentle way, you can shake the world. - Gandhi

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The philosophers have only interpreted the world in various way. The point, however is to change it - Marx

Religion is the opium of the masses.

Aristotle
- poverty is the parent of revn & crime.

Good people do not need laws to tell them to act responsibly, while bad people will find a way around the laws. - Plato

Men are mortal. so are ideas. An idea needs propagation as much as a plant needs watering. Otherwise both will wither & die - Ambedhkar

India of the ages is not dead, nor has she spoken her last creative word; she lives & has still something to do for herself & the human peoples - Aurobindo

Education is the kindling of a flame, not filling of a vessel. - Socrates

Free people, remember this maxim : we may acquire liberty, but it is never recovered if it is once lost. - Rousseau

Useless laws weaken the necessary laws - Montesquieu
- The severity of laws prevents their execution.
- Countries are well cultivated, not as they are fertile, but as they are free.

If you can't feed a 100 people then feed just one.
There are no great things. only small things done with love.

Do not wait for leaders. do it alone, person to person.

- Mother Teresa

Action orientation !

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Environment

From a Chipko pamphalet of 1974 : "If trees remain. the mountains remain & so does the country. If trees remain, there will be no flooding in Alaknanda & other rivers. To be against trees is to deny your own identity. Destruction of trees is the destruction of common person."

Relativity applies to Physics, not Ethics - Einstein.

Learning | Knowledge | struggle

One Friday morning an eager young Stanford Uni student stood before Louis Janin, a well known mining Er. He was seeking empt. Janin informed him, "All I need is a stenographer rn."
They young man said," Fine, I'll take the job but I can't come back until Tuesday".
Janin agreed and the next Tuesday, the young man reported for work.
"why is it that you couldn't come for all these days?" he enquired. The young man replied, "Because I had to rent a typewriter and learn how to use it "

The young typist was Herbert Hoover, whose can-do attitude eventually led him through the doors of the White House to become one of America's Presidents.

Your willingness to learn today will prepare you for tomorrow's opportunities. No skill you learn will ever be lost. All successful people have one thing in common - They never quit learning!

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Poverty

Overcoming poverty is not a task of charity, it is an act of justice. (Like slavery & Apartheid, poverty is not natural) It is man-made & it can be overcome & eradicated by the actions of human beings. (Sometimes it falls on a generation to be great. YOU can be that great generation. Let your greatness blossom)

- Nelson Mandela.

Play is the highest form of research - Einstein

The Silence Retreat

4 monks decided to meditate silently w/o speaking for 2 ~~word~~ weeks. They began with enthusiasm & nobody said a word the whole day. By nightfall, the candle began to flicker & then went out.

1st monk - Oh no! The candle is out!
2nd - Hey! We're not supposed to speak!
3rd - What is this? Why did you 2 break the silence?
4th - Wow! I'm the only one who hasn't spoken!

Each monk broke the silence for a diff reason, each of which is a common stumbling block in our inner journey: distraction, judgement, anger & pride!

"It is the province of knowledge to speak, it is the privilege of wisdom to listen".

As we learn to truly listen, witness & observe w/o impulsively reacting with distraction, judgement, anger & pride, then we understand the true meaning of silence.

Man vs Tech

Elon Musk - Comp are much smarter than humans on so many dimensions.

Jack Ma - comp may be 'clever'. but human beings are much smarter (We invented the comp - We never seen a comp invent a human being)

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Peace / one world

Imagine there are no countries
It isn't hard to do
Nothing to kill or die for
And no religion too
Imagine all the people
Living life in peace.

You may say that I'm dreamer
But I'm not the only one
I hope someday you'll join us
And the world will be as one

– John Lennon

Courage / overcoming disabilities / positive outlook

Raymond Clarence Ewry – An American track & field athlete was among the most successful olympians of all time as per some.
He won only 10 medals but they were all Olympic Gold !

No, it is not just his medals & his win over other competitors. It was in part his win over his own weakness. As a child, Ewry suffered from polio & for a short while, he was dependent on a wheelchair. He feared becoming paralysed for life.

Through hardwork & courage he defeated his illness & then his competitors to become one of the greatest athlete ever!

The saying "you must do the thing which you think you cannot do" never held so true as in the case of Raymond Clarence Ewry.

Education & Teacher

– Aristotle

- Those who know, do. Those that understand, teach.
- I cannot teach anybody anything. I can only make them think – Socrates
- (c) affect eternity, no one can tell where their influence stops – HB Adams

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It matters not how strait the gate
How charged with punishments the scroll
I am the master of my fate
I am the captain of my soul. - William Ernest Henley.

Attitude

3 people were laying bricks & a passerby asked them what they were doing. The 1st one replied -

"Dont you see I am making a living?"

2nd - "Dont you see I am laying bricks?"

3rd - "I am building a beautiful monument."

The difference lies in the attitude and attitude affects performance.

Hardwork | Dedication | Perserwarence | Never say die

When a bullet pierces both, your body & your dreams. as a 20yr old with your whole life ahead of you,

can you find a reason to smile?

Can you power through the pain? put destiny in her place? shift focus from half empty to half full?

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play when walking is doubtful? Captain your country? Be an Arjuna awardee?

Yes, you can.
And no, it wasn't easy. The life lessons didn't come for free but have to believe in "me".
Find in that one crucial moment of adversity a smile!
- Sandeep Singh, gunshot survivor & former India hockey captain.

Employment

Amartya Sen had once quipped that India's empt figures were low enough to put many developed countries to shame.
Professor Sen was ofcourse not commending the country's record on empt creation but instead highlighting the difficulties involved in measuring empt & unempt in a developing country.

India

India is the cradle of human race, the birthplace of human speech, the mother of history, the grandmother of legend & the great grandmother of traditions. Our most valuable & most instructive materials in the history of man are treasured up in India only
- Mark Twain.

Fear

On his first inaugral address during the depths of Great Depression, US Presi Franklin D Roosevelt famously told Americans that.

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The only thing we have to fear is fear itself. Invoking the BOOK of Exodus, he went on to say that "we are stricken by no plague of locusts". Nothing tangible was causing the depression, the problem in March 1933 was in people's minds.

One machine can do the work of 50 ordinary men. There is no machine that can do the work of one extraordinary man.

We worked hard to achieve our freedom, we shall have to strive harder to justify it -

- Sardar Patel.

Men build too many walls & not enough bridges - Newton

Women

At the rate we're going, it will take 99.5 years to achieve gender parity, acc to WEF. It won't be until the year ~~201~~ 2119 when women throughout the world will have equal outcomes & oppo across health, edu^{n}, economy & pol. The report highlights the need for companies, govts & leaders to act right now to address gender gaps. This is urgent & a century is way, way too long to wait.

While students are just 10% of our pop^{n}, they are 100% of our future.

The tragedy of life is not that we aim too high & miss it, but that we aim too low & achieve it.

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Two prisoners look out from the prison cell. One looks at the mud below, the other at the moon above.

- Bryan Dyson, former CEO of coca Cola perceives life as a game in which we are juggling with balls in air - work, health, family, friends & spirit. A few are rubber balls, a few glass.

✓ A blind person asked Swami Vivekananda, 'can there be anything worse than losing the eyesight'? The Swami replied, 'Yes, losing your vision!'

✓ Success introduces us to the world & failures introduce the world to us.

✓ Shakespeare rightly said, 'laughing faces do not mean there is no absence of sorrow. But it means they have the ability to deal with it'.

If we can't find the brighter side of life, & then we must learn to polish the darker side.

- The purpose of life is a life of purpose

✓ He who gives no light shall never become a star

- You don't have to see the whole staircase, just take the 1st step - Martin Luther King

- Shakespeare - to do a great right, do a little wrong

- (I am a greater believer in luck. The harder I work, the more I have of it - Thomas Jefferson.)

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Milkha Singh

A 16 year old boy saw his family murdered during the partition. Homeless in India, he briefly served time in Tihar jail, turned to a life of stealing & reportedly even considered becoming a dacoit. However, a job in the army helped the 'legend' discover his life's calling as he became the country's most celebrated runner and recieved the title of 'Flying Sikh'.

Achievements - 1st I to reach the final in Athletics at the Olympics
1st I to win an ind athletics gold at CWG.

Flying sikh title given by Ayub Khan in Pak. Orphaned by partn, he united the two countries

Despite his many successes, it was his one near miss (0.1 seconds missed to bronze) that remains Milkha's most famous race - 1960 Tokyo olympics

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Crime against women

2019. November 29. The country woke up to the news of a group of men raping a 27 year old vet doctor from TL & burning her to death.

Around the same time in 2012, another unlucky woman went for the last bus ride of her life. They called her 'Nirbhaya' – the one who is not afraid. It was because she fought until her body gave up. She paid a big price for being Nirbhaya, didn't she?

What followed were condolences & apologies. Candle marches & slogans. Debates & blame game.
And, nothing changed.

Lamenting upon the deteriorating r/ship b/w nature & man and man & society, the greatest poet of his time, William Wordsworth wrote –

If we all being sent from heaven
If such was a nature's holy plan
Isn't it a reason to lament?
What ~~has~~ man has made of a man?

My name is Ozymandias, King of kings
Look on my works, ye Mighty and despair!
Nothing beside remains. Round the decay
Of that colossal wreck, boundless & bare
The lone & level sands stretch far away.

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I have a Dream - Martin Luther King Jr

Adapted → When the architects of our republic wrote the magnificent words of our @, they were signing a promissory note to which every Indian was to fall heir.

It is obvious today that India has defaulted on this promissory note, insofar as its citizens / women / Dalits etc etc are concerned. Instead of honouring this sacred obligation, India has given its people a bad cheque, stating insufficient funds.

But we refuse to believe that bank of justice is bankrupt. we refuse to accept that there are insufficient funds in the great vaults of oppo of this nation

Child Labour

We have entered in 21st C.
By performing great deeds
Exploiting the little angels
Has become our daily need.

A simple question to our decayed mentality

Hopeful eyes, happy smiles
Soft hands, million dreams
Is this not the identity of a child?
Why do they have to bear their
master's rod?
Are they children of a lesser God?

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Climate Change

Green Preamble

"We, the citizens of Mother Earth, solemnly resolve to create this world into a clean, green & pristine place and to permeate among all, the pious traits of sustainable development, maintaining the dignity of our nature & ensuring prosperity for all living beings."

we walked on moon, we saw the mars
we are heading to interstellar
But how do we live on Earth?
we need to ask a fortune teller!

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Climate change / Human wrongs

Humans - the most intelligent of species on this planet. Or maybe even in this universe, until time proves otherwise.

The perfect culmination of the evolution curve.

The masters of the land, the sea & the sky.

The bravehearts who tamed wild elephants, ferocious lines and galloping horses.

The thinkers who outthought the rest.

The inventors of fire, the wheel & the power to dream.

The virtuosos who unified the world through song & made it a small place.

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The artists who painted ceilings divine.
The singers who made skies weep.
The writers who penned history. And the visionaries, who wrote the future.
We are the wizards who turned air into water & water into light.
The brains who fought diseases & delayed death. The Einsteins, the Teslas & the Musks.
The geniuses that put a vehicle on the Red Planet, a man on the faraway moon & that plastic bag in the vast ocean!

"You can't build peace on empty stomachs"
- Norman Borlaug, 1970 Nobel Peace Prize.

His story of Green Revn demonstrates how the combo of science, edu & social entship can transform the world - save mns of lives.

"I refuse to accept that the world is so poor when just one week of global military exp. can bring all our children into classrooms."
- Kailash Satyarthi, 2014 Nobel Peace Prize.

"If one girl can change the world, what can 130 mn girls do?"
In 2012, Malala Yousafzai was shot 3 times in an attempt to stop her from speaking out for girls edu. Today, the Nobel laureate is a leading advocate for girls rights.

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Climate Change

In April 1970 the first Earth Day was inspired by a photograph from Apollo 8. an Image of Earth as a fragile blue ball in the vastness of space. Many hoped this vision of a vulnerable world would catalyse env'al consciousness & bring a planetary healing, dissipating the rancour of social & pol antagonism. As the 50th anni of this moment nears, in 2020 we seem to be edging even closer to ecological catastrophe. And yet the alternative remains.

Motivation & Grit

If experts were to be believed, after the total destruction in WW II Japan had NO future. But the same Japan in just 3 decades or so made US cry at the marketplace.

If experts were to believed, Israel should have been wiped out from world map by Arabs but the fact is diff.

As per the rules of aerodynamics. the Bumble Bee cannot fly but it flies because it does not know the rules of aer.

If . . . , we ~~so~~ should have been nowhere in 83 world cup, Willima Rudolf, the 1st American lady to win 4 gold olympics in Athletics should not have been in a position to walk

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- If we want to learn about somebody who didn't quit despite repeated failures only to savour the fruits of success eventually, we should look no further than the celebrated US President Abraham Lincoln.

Seeing the trajectory of his life, one can easily say that no defeat is final until we stop trying. Born into poverty, Lincoln was faced with numerous defeats - he lost 8 elections, twice failed in business & suffered a nervous breakdown.

- William Arthur said opportunities are like sunrises. If we wait for too long, we may miss them.

- while some succeed because they are destined to, most succeed because they are determined to.

- Failure should never go to heart & success should never go to head.

- When the Goliath of fear knocks the door, we must send David of courage to open the door.

- The Leaning Tower of Pisa is actually a mistake but it has immortalized its architect.

- Even when everything is lost, future still remains.

- All arguments have 2 sides, but no end.

- A good newspaper, I suppose, is a nation talking to itself" - Arthur Miller

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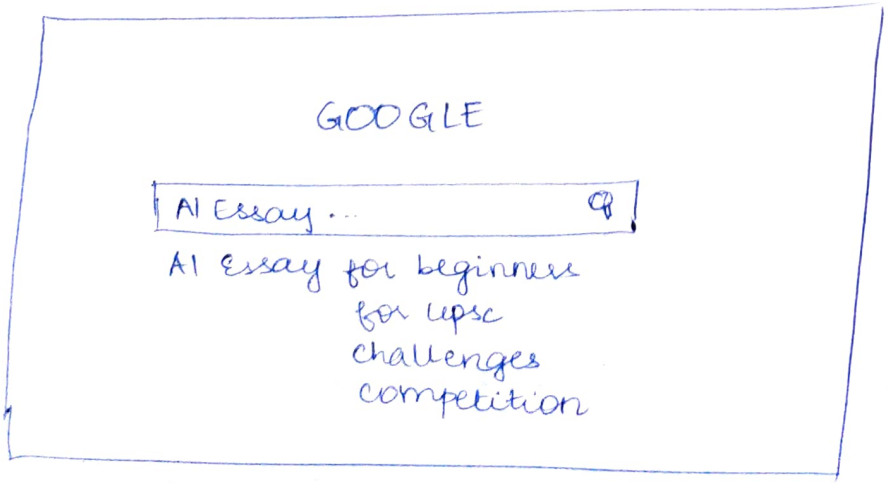
Bob Dylan's words :

"How many times a man look up, before he really sees the sky?
How many ears must a man have before he can hear people cry?

How many deaths will it take to know that too many people have died? The answer, my friend is blowing in the wind.

- Today is brutal, tomorrow is more brutal. but the day after tomorrow is beautiful. However, the majority of people will die tomorrow night.
- Silicon valley entrepreneurs celebrate previously failed ventures on their Tshirts - a recognition that some failure is unavoidable, some desirable.
- Technology can't replace teachers but tech in the hands of teachers can be transformational.

AI



India has walked a long road to freedom. It has even made some missteps on the way and after climbing great hills the nation has discovered that there are many more to climb. It can definitely wait & steal the view of a glorious

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vista that surrounds it but it can only rest for a moment for with freedom comes responsibilities & it dare not linger, for its long walk has not yet ended.

- When the whole world is silent, even one voice becomes powerful - Malala
- Year 1AC - After coronavirus
- Indira Gandhi once said Forest Dev corp had become Forest Destruction corp
- Geography has no borders - its history that creates them, erases them & recreates them with the link of time.
  Geog provides a country with neighbours but history is what makes them partners, allies or enemy.
- "We are just an advanced breed of monkeys on a minor planet of a very average star. But we can understand the Universe. That makes us something very special" - Stephen Hawkings

Techno progress has merely provided us more efficient ways of going backwards.

- AI & Children

We are now living among history's very 1st "AI Gen". From the Alexas they converse with, to their robot playmate to the Yt wormholes they disappear into, the children & adolescents of today are born into a world fully powered by VR & AI.

AI is not only changing what humans can do, it is shaping our behaviours, our preferences, our perceptions of the world and of ourselves. What does the world of AI

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mean for the older generation & for us? for children & their parents? Let us explore.

- Before gaining enlightenment, Buddha once gave up eating & drinking & sat in meditation. However, after a few weeks, he felt weak & dizzy due to no nourishment & found impossible to meditate further. At that time some village women happened to pass by, carrying water pots and singing a song that meant -

'Tighten the strings of Tanpura. But do not tighten them so much that it breaks.'

The Buddha then exclaimed that these illiterate women know the true way of leading life - 'Golden Middle Path' b/w severe asceticism & sensual Indulgence / mindless hedonism

- Gandhi essay - can begin with Lage Raho Munna Bhai plot & how he used Gandhigiri to solve problems of ordinary people.

End with - Churchill dismissed him as 'Naked Fakir', Nobel Committee ignored his greatest contributions, radical elements went to the extent of killing him. But Gandhi never died. His Ideas lives on! His life story & lessons immortalised him and Gandhigiri continues to be the emergency lamp in an otherwise darkened world.

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"There are decades when nothing happens & weeks when decades happen"

This was the most frequently shared quote in 2020 and quite rightly so. This year changed our perception of time & showed us the flip side of life. 2020 has a year that caught us off guard. a year that felt like a Shakesperean catharsis.

- Perseverance. Joe Biden is not an overnight success. He took 50 years to get where he is today. He ran for Prsi in 1988, 2008 only to get third time lucky in 2020. Some things in life take time.

Judiciary

During the 2nd WW, when the Luftwaffe (German Air Force) was wreaking havoc over London with its incessant bombing attacks, the British PM Winston Churchill took cognizance of heavy casualties & economic devastation.

While he was briefed on casualties & economic collapse, he asked.. "Are the courts functioning"? When told that the judges were dispensing justice as normal. Churchill said.

"Thank God. If the courts are working. nothing can go wrong".

- MLK once said. "To other countries I may go as a tourist, but to India, I come as a pilgrim".

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• One of the famous Yakshaprashna to the Yudhisthra in Mahabharata was:

"what is the greatest wonder on earth?"

"Day after day, countless people die. Yet the living wishes to live forever." ① replied.

① answer states the anomaly of human behaviour. Where every human being knows that he is heading towards death but still wishes to live forever)

• In Arvinda Adigha's White Tiger, the protagonist makes a comment about the role of geography in dev^t India is 2 countries, he says. One is the India of light, & the other is India of darkness. The ocean brings light to the country - every region near the ocean is well off. But the river brings darkness to India.

• Economic Big Bang theory - EBB happened with IR. Some countries thrown on high growth trajectory.

Wealth of Rich & Poor = 3:1 in 1820s
its 100:1 now.

• § How can one not speak about war, poverty & inequality when people who suffer from these inflictions don't have a voice to speak? § Isabel Allende

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More than 50 years ago, Leo Tolstoy, one of the greatest novelists and thinkers of the world, writing in his book - What Then We Must Do wondered and asked :

If everything of value and substance is produced in the rural areas, why then are the villages mired in poverty and cities awash in wealth ?

The question continues to befuddle us.

- Mohd Yunus cited N. & S. Korean athletes marching under ~~the sun~~ one flag at opening ceremony of 2018 Pyeongchang Winter Games as an example of the Olympics using sports to create peace.

1936. Berlin Olympics. It was the biggest sporting event in the world and the best chance for Hitler to further his agenda of Aryan Supremacy.

James Cleveland Owens, a 23 yr old Afro American from Alabama, singlehandedly dashed the propaganda by putting on a performance That made him the most successful athlete ~~for~~ the games

He won 4 golds for his country and a battle for his Race.

- "Sometimes I want to ask God why he allows poverty, famine & injustice when he could eradicate it all but I'm afraid he might just ask me the same question"
  - Abdul-Baha (Bahai faith leader).

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Simplest of living being in this world strives for his own survival & fulfilling his own needs. So what makes us humans a superior species? Yuval Noah Harari in his book Sapiens has argued that it is our unique ability to cooperate & work towards common goals by attaching meaning to them

"If I were asked under what sky the human mind has most fully developed some of its choicest gifts, has most deeply pondered on the greatest problems of life & has found solutions, I should point to India"

– Max Muller

- Tiger got to hunt, bird got to fly
  Man got to sit & wonder, "why, why, why?"
  Tiger got to sleep, bird got to land
  Man got to tell himself he understand.

- About a 100 yrs ago, a man looked at the morning newspaper & to his surprise & horror, read his name in the obituary column. The newspaper had reported the death of a wrong person by mistake.
  The obituary read, "Dynamite King dies". He was the merchant of death.
  He asked himself is this how I am going to be remembered?
  From that day on, he started working towards peace.
  His name was Alfred Nobel, & he is greatly remembered for the Nobel Prize.

- I start early and I stay late, day after day, year after year, it took me 17 years and 114 days to become an overnight success - Lionel Messi.

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- Lives of great men all remind us,
we can make our lives sublime,
& departing, leave behind us
footprints on the sands of time.

— Henry Wordsworth Longfellow.

- For a bamboo tree, no growth is visible on ground for 1st 4 yrs. The only thing growing out of ground is a little bulb with a small shoot coming out of it.
Each year the tree is fertilised, cultivated & watered & still no growth is visible. Then, in the 5th year, the bamboo tree grows upto 30m in 6 weeks.

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